

3.1.14 Bondi Road**Figure 63** Bondi Road Centre**Existing Character and Built Form**

Bondi Road is an important and busy transport corridor that runs along the 'spine' connecting Bondi Beach to Bondi Junction and the City. The existence of numerous bus stops draw people to Bondi Road, increasing pedestrian presence. A strength of the village is good pedestrian accessibility to the retail shops from a relatively large residential catchment.

The strip is composed of smaller 'shop house' buildings of a scale which are reflective of the historical small scale lot subdivision pattern. Buildings are generally two (2) storeys to the street edge, having an effective height, due to the existence of parapets and roof forms, of three (3) levels.

A number of contradictions exist in the form of larger high rise 1960's and 1970's residential and hotel towers. These buildings are inconsistent with the overall scale of the street fabric. Lower podium levels of the building (lower two (2) to three (3) levels) tend to have front and side setbacks inconsistent with adjoining development and the rhythm of the streetscape. All existing buildings of historic character are mixed use, with commercial ground floor and residential upper storey(s).

Numerous buildings within this area possess elements of, or largely intact, original shop-fronts. Many other buildings preserve the original entry configuration (i.e. with inset doorway to one side) reconstructed with contemporary materials.

The Bondi Road centre comprises of three distinct existing characters: West Bondi Road, Central Bondi Road and East Bondi Road. A distinct character exists between the western end and eastern end of Bondi Road, both in built form and the public domain.

The western end of Bondi Road, closer to Bondi Junction, has a less consistent character when compared to the eastern end. The western end has more diverse land use offerings, with a mix of retail, hospitality and personal services. The built form is inconsistent with a former service station, a range of residential and shop-top housing buildings, and public buildings such as St Patrick's Catholic Church and the Waverley Woollahra Arts School.